

FarCry 4

Come this fall and we'll have ourselves another chapter of FarCry with the storyline taking place in the Himalayas. <http://dgit.in/NearCry4>



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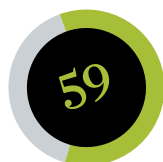
Edifier M1386

Elegant, compact multimedia speaker



Price
₹3,490

The first thing you'll notice about the Edifier M1386 is its size. The subwoofer isn't one of those massive boxes which you invariably end up using as a footstool. The satellites are not that small but well designed and aesthetically pleasing. The driver is housed in a suspended stand-based design with faux-chrome accents running along the bottom edge. Good looks overall, no chinks.



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Value for money	60

Specifications

Output power: 8W x 2 satellites + 14W subwoofer (RMS); **Driver size:** 2.75-inch satellites, 5-inch subwoofer; **Frequency response:** 140 Hz - 20 KHz satellites, 50 Hz - 130 KHz subwoofer; **Dimension:** Subwoofer: 120x151x125 mm, Satellite: 164x200x280 mm

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The speaker is fairly feature rich. It supports multiple sources including USB and SD Card and unlike most speakers in this price range the ports aren't located on the hard-to-reach back panel of the woofer, instead they're located on the wired remote pod. The pod has buttons for volume, playback, muting and input source toggle. It even has a tiny LCD screen which is a neat little addition. The speaker has built in FM radio but the reception wasn't great – much less compared to the F&D A530U.

The speaker isn't very loud – not surprising considering its small footprint and 30W RMS rating – but it's enough for a mid size room. The sound doesn't distort even when you push it past the 80 percent volume mark. Even at high volume the crossover unit seems to be sending the right frequencies to the tweeter and woofer. The clarity and overall performance didn't make us sit up and take notice but it fits squarely between the Umax Boombastic USP 3200 and the F&D F680, which is precisely where it's priced. A good value for money option for those looking for 2.1 speakers.

Siddharth Parwatay

ASRock Z97 Extreme6

It would be accurate to call this board a peripheral junction

ASRock's entrant onto the Z97 scene has something that we've not seen on the other Z97 boards so far and that's the Ultra M.2 slot. While other boards used PCIE 2.0 to get 10 Gbps on the M.2 slot, ASRock has used PCIE 3.0 to increase the bandwidth to 32Gbps. Moreover, they've even made space for a Mini PCIE slot which sits below the M.2 slot. So we can say that they've made an efficient use of real estate.

ASRock has departed from the earlier colour scheme of black and gold. On the Z97 Extreme6 we get to see a new black and blue scheme with tall VRM heat sinks. All the capacitors on the board aren't



Price
₹14,995

solid state and this might seem to be a drawback at first glance.

However, these turned out to be premium Nichicon capacitors which cater to the audio codec. Not to mention, this board too has an isolated section which has become more and more common as of now.

A new feature that this board comes with is the ability to power two SATA devices (HDD or ODD) via the motherboard instead of the PSU. This way these two devices can be turned off at anytime to save power which is something you can do through your OS as well but that never shuts down power completely. Two other things that stand out are the presence of two USB 3.0 headers and a Thunderbolt AIC connector. The board does not have PCI slots or v-check points but it makes up for those by incorporating features like Thunderbolt AIC and Ultra M.2.



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Specifications

Chipset: Intel Z97; **Memory support:** 4x3200(OC)MHz upto 32GB; **LAN:** Realtek 8111GR and Intel Gigabit Ethernet; **Audio:** ALC1150 7.1; **SATA:** 10x SATA III; **Expansion:** PCIe x16, 2x PCIe x16(x8+x4); **Dimensions (LxWxD):** 305 mm x 244 mm; **Warranty:** 3 years

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